

CS-UY 4513 In-Class Activity #2 Deliverable

Project Description / Feature List / Technical Stack

Complete the following table of team member names / emails / presence today in class.

Name	Email @nyu	Present in class: Y/N
CJ Thomas	cst9351@nyu.edu	Y
Isabel Ayres	ira9149@nyu.edu	Y
Sanjan Gadde	sg8147@nyu.edu	Y
Alex Zhu	ayz2057@nyu.edu	Y
Oleksandran Kovalenko	ok2178@nyu.edu	N
Justin Sun	jjs10109@nyu.edu	N

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Project Vision & Context

Explain the core vision for your Ruby on Rails application. For each section below, write 2-3 paragraphs addressing the following questions. Do not list specific features, page routes, or user workflows in this section. A detailed feature list will be submitted soon. Focus purely on what the application is, who it is for, and why it needs to exist. This section will be shared in Brightspace with all students in the course sections.

What problem does your application address?

Centralized discussion board for New York City Infra outages/ problems. Calls attention to dangerous issues that might be overlooked by the city, especially in underserved areas.

Citizens, especially those in underserved areas often lack a formal way to publicize infrastructure outages within their neighborhoods. This could potentially lead to deterioration of infrastructure, harm to citizens, and lack of ease of transport.

What is your application's target audience or user base?

Residents in New York City from more 'neglected' areas who feel that their problems (relating to infrastructure, e.g. potholes, sidewalk obstructions, etc.) aren't being adequately addressed. Also those who want to be more active in their very local community, i.e. neighborhood/block, either through volunteering (to address the easier problems themselves) and/or giving input on what problems they believe to be more urgent than others (maybe through up/downvotes)

The overall value proposition (your "elevator pitch"). For more information on the elevator pitch, [see this link from MIT](#).

Do you know *the* pothole? *That* leaking fire hydrant? *That* tree that's been blocking the sidewalk for months? And even if you don't, you can still imagine how these things are everywhere in a city like NYC, right? So what if you could do something about it? Report it to a platform that could actually provide the government and volunteers with what you and your community find the most urgent? We aim to do that via localized forum approach where you can upload pictures and comments on infrastructure issues and vote on what's most important.

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Technical Stack Breakdown

List the core technologies, tools, and libraries you intend to use to build and deploy your application. If a choice is still tentative, note your top choice.

- Backend & Framework: (e.g., Ruby 3.x, Rails 7.x/8.x)
Ruby on Rails
- Database: (e.g., PostgreSQL, SQLite, MySQL)
NoSQL - easier to deal with in json format, no need for strong consistency or data analysis since we will most likely be storing comments and other user data
Hosting: ScyllaDB, DynamoDB, Cassandra
- Frontend / UI Strategy: (e.g., ERB + Tailwind CSS, Hotwire/Turbo/Stimulus, React API-only backend, etc.)
- Authentication / Authorization: (e.g., Devise, OmniAuth, custom has_secure_password, Pundit/CanCanCan)
OmniAuth for Oauth implementation in Ruby
- Key Gems & Third-Party APIs: (e.g., Active Storage + AWS S3, Stripe API, Sidekiq/Redis, Faraday, etc.)

Blob / file storage : AWS S3
Caching: Redis or AWS ElastiCache
- Additional Services (Cache, Messaging Service, SMS, Email, etc.)

Resend (email alerts)

- External APIs
NYCOpenData (nyc.gov) (SODA API), Google Flood Forecaster API, Foursquare,
maybe something that has like residential data for verification,